Printing Equipment



Category: **Computers, IT & Office** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Printing Set Up Equipment

What it is used for

Printing equipment is used to produce hard copies of documents, drawings, labels, and training materials. Follow the correct setup, operating, and maintenance procedures to obtain clear prints and prevent equipment damage.

Main parts

- Printer or multifunction printing machine
- Power cable and power switch
- USB or network connection cable
- Paper tray and paper guides
- Ink cartridges or toner cartridges
- Control panel and display
- Output tray and access covers

Before you start

1. Place the printer on a stable, level, well-ventilated surface.
2. Check the power cable, plug, and electrical supply for damage.
3. Confirm that the correct ink or toner is installed.
4. Load the recommended paper size and adjust the paper guides.
5. Check the computer connection, printer driver, and selected printer settings.
6. Ensure access covers are closed and no paper jam is present.

How to use

1. Switch on the printer and wait until it completes initialization.
2. Connect the printer to the computer or approved network if required.
3. Open the document and select the correct printer from the print menu.
4. Set paper size, orientation, colour mode, print quality, and number of copies.
5. Use print preview to check page layout and content.
6. Send one test page and inspect text, images, alignment, and colour.
7. Print the remaining pages after confirming the test result.
8. Collect printed sheets from the output tray and check for missing pages.
9. Switch off the equipment according to the manufacturer's instructions when finished.

⚠ Safety

- Keep hands dry when operating power switches and electrical connections.
- Never touch exposed electrical parts or dismantle the printer while powered.
- Do not touch hot fuser components inside laser printers.
- Keep liquids, loose metal objects, and food away from the equipment.
- Use only compatible paper, ink, toner, and approved accessories.
- Follow the manufacturer's instructions when clearing paper jams.

Care & storage

- Clean accessible surfaces with a soft, dry cloth when the equipment is off.
- Keep paper trays and the output area free from dust and scraps.
- Replace cartridges and maintenance parts according to manufacturer guidance.
- Report repeated jams, unusual noises, streaks, or error messages.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Loading the wrong paper size or placing paper incorrectly in the tray.
- Selecting an incorrect printer, page range, or print orientation.
- Using incompatible cartridges or refilling cartridges against manufacturer guidance.
- Pulling jammed paper forcefully and damaging internal rollers.
- Ignoring low-supply warnings or continuing to print with recurring defects.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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